STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

Uganda: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-4 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Public debate and participation in policymaking

Strategies, plans and policies

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY

- **Uganda Targets AI Sovereignty, Minister Says** — Nile Post, 10 September 2026

  Uganda is developing an artificial intelligence strategy aimed at building national capacity to develop, govern and benefit from the technology rather than depend on foreign systems, its science and technology minister said. He named data, computing infrastructure, energy, models, applications and skills as the foundations that need investment.

DOMESTIC TAXES COMPLIANCE RISK MANAGEMENT STRATEGY

- **URA unveils data driven tax compliance strategy for FY2026/27** — Eagle Online, 14 September 2026

  The Uganda Revenue Authority began implementing its taxpayer compliance risk management strategy and compliance improvement plan for 2026/27. It will use taxpayer records, transaction data and sector trends to target evasion, inaccurate declarations, non-registration and late filing, and prioritises compliance with the EFRIS e-invoicing system and digital tax stamps.

NATIONAL COMMUNICATION POLICY, 2026

- **Government Launches National Communication Policy 2026** — Ministry of ICT and National Guidance (Uganda), 13 October 2026

  Uganda's Minister of ICT and National Guidance, Justine Kasule Lumumba, launched the National Communication Policy, 2026 in Kampala on 13 October 2026. It sets common communication standards for ministries, agencies and local governments, covering crisis communication, access to public information and citizen feedback, and requires each to adopt and budget for an aligned communication strategy.

Legislation and regulation

UCC ORDER SUSPENDING PUBLIC INTERNET

- **Uganda Communications Commission explains internet shutdown** — New Vision, 7 September 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator published the text of its suspension directive: public internet, new SIM sales and outbound data roaming stopped, mobile VPNs disabled, a whitelisted exclusion list from referral hospitals to railway signalling, and restoration only on written notice.

DIGITAL LENDING PLATFORM REGULATION

- **Uganda's central bank to probe claims mobile money users are paying off strangers' loans** — Kikubolane, 15 September 2026

  Bank of Uganda governor Michael Atingi-Ego told a parliamentary committee on 14 September 2026 that the bank will investigate claims that mobile money operators it supervises, MTN and Airtel, helped digital lenders recover unpaid loans from the wallets of people listed as guarantors without consent. Standalone digital lenders fall under the finance ministry, not the central bank.

- **MTN, Airtel deny deducting customers' money without consent** — PML Daily, 16 September 2026

  MTN Uganda and Airtel Uganda told Parliament's public enterprises committee, reported on 16 September 2026, that they do not deduct customers' money without consent or require loan guarantors, and that they only provide platforms for licensed lenders. They asked the Uganda Communications Commission to block unlicensed lending apps. The committee has summoned 58 online lending companies over recoveries from people named as guarantors without consent.

RESTRICTION OF REPEAT ONLINE OFFENDERS

- **Uganda proposes stricter measures against serial cyber offenders** — CAJ News Africa, 15 September 2026

  The communications regulator said it is working with parliament on a framework allowing targeted denial of service to repeat abusers of cyberspace, its director likening the measure to withdrawing a driving licence. No bill, offence definition or appeal route is published.

UCC ENFORCEMENT AGAINST UNLICENSED PUBLIC WI-FI

- **UCC Reviews Crackdown on Unauthorised Wi-Fi Operators After Complaints** — Nile Post, 12 October 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator said it is reviewing its enforcement against unauthorised Wi-Fi and hotspot resellers after complaints from operators. A public notice was promised within the week.

- **Press Release on Illegal Wi-Fi Hotspots** — Uganda Communications Commission, 13 October 2026

  The Uganda Communications Commission said on 13 October 2026 that about 4,000 unlicensed operators resell public Wi-Fi at UGX 1,000 per GB against UGX 2,000 from licensed providers, costing about UGX 148 billion a year in tax. The Uganda Revenue Authority will block equipment imports by unlicensed operators, and a nationwide exercise to take down installations and seize routers is imminent.

Data protection

PROSECUTIONS FOR UNLAWFUL DISCLOSURE OF PERSONAL DATA

- **Three arrested over alleged fake news, personal data offences on social media** — Nilepost, 1 September 2026

  Kampala police confirmed on 1 September 2026 that three men are held at Jinja Road Police Station over alleged fake news and unlawful obtaining or disclosure of personal data on social media in July. The case rests on Uganda's Computer Misuse Act, whose offences carry up to 10 years in prison. Police have not named the posts, platforms, victims or charges.

- **TikToker charged over alleged fake news, data disclosure** — New Vision, 7 October 2026

  A TikTok user was charged in Kampala on 6 October with unlawfully obtaining and disclosing personal data under Uganda's data protection act, and with publishing false news, over a photograph and video of a State House employee. He denied the charges; the case returns on 19 October.

COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR'S CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION CAMPAIGN

- **Uganda Launches Child Online Protection Campaign to Promote Safer Internet Use** — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator launched a child online protection campaign at a Kampala secondary school, to teach children to recognise and manage online risks. The ICT permanent secretary called on parents, schools, technology companies and government to share the work.

Regional collaboration

UGANDA-SOUTH SUDAN CROSS-BORDER HEALTH SECURITY MEMORANDUM

- **South Sudan, Uganda sign agreement on cross-border health security** — Radio Tamazuj, 8 September 2026

  SOUTH SUDAN

  South Sudan and Uganda's health ministers signed a memorandum of understanding in Juba on cross-border health security, reported on 8 September 2026. It provides for real-time sharing of epidemiological information, mutual outbreak notification, joint contact tracing and surveillance, biospecimen transfer and harmonised screening at points of entry.

CUSTOMS COOPERATION MEMORANDUM WITH THE SOUTH SUDAN REVENUE AUTHORITY

- **South Sudan, Uganda Sign MoU to Strengthen Customs Cooperation** — Juba Echo TV, 16 September 2026

  SOUTH SUDAN

  The South Sudan Revenue Authority and the Uganda Revenue Authority signed their third memorandum of understanding on customs cooperation, reported on 16 September 2026, covering modernisation, digital interoperability, transit trade and capacity building. New areas include enforcement of the electronic permit system. No commencement date or text is given.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

URA E-TAX2 AWARD

- **URA engages manufacturers on new tax reforms, digital systems and import fee changes** — Mulengera News, 11 September 2026

  The Uganda Revenue Authority told manufacturers on 11 September 2026 that its eTax2 platform, in development since February 2026, will be web-only and will replace Tax Identification Numbers with National Identification Numbers and Business Registration Numbers. URA said the change is meant to fix duplicate and fragmented records in the taxpayer register.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity · Data Storage · Cybersecurity

Connectivity

SMARTPHONES IN USE

- **UCC launches study on smartphone usage as Uganda targets universal coverage by 2030** — The Independent / URN, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator launched a study of smartphone penetration, device cost and usage, against a stated target of full national network coverage by 2030.

STARLINK OPERATIONAL LICENCE

- **Govt welcomes Starlink internet service provider** — New Vision, 2 September 2026

Starlink began commercial service in Uganda, ending the regulatory process that followed a memorandum and a five-year operating licence signed with the communications regulator in May 2026. The licence requires a national gateway and physical point of presence, an operational office, and registration of every device activated in the country.

- **Starlink goes live in Uganda; price comparisons against MTN, Airtel** — Pulse Uganda, 2 September 2026

  Prices published with the Ugandan launch put a residential 100 Mbps package at Shs203,704 a month against an estimated Shs2.3 million to start, plus a Shs437,036 regulatory charge — against fibre offers from the two mobile incumbents advertised at Shs110,000 and Shs99,000 for the same speed.

UGANDA-TANZANIA FIBRE ROUTE ON THE TRANSMISSION NETWORK

- **UETCL in Spotlight Over Uganda-Tanzania Fibre Connection** — Nile Post, 4 September 2026

  Uganda's parliamentary committee on state enterprises questioned the Uganda Electricity Transmission Company (UETCL) over the cancellation of open bidding for a partner to commercialise its fibre network. The energy ministry directed the termination in 2026 and Samanga Utilities was then considered for a Uganda–Tanzania fibre link, following a presidential directive of August 2025 seeking cheaper internet routes than those through Kenya.

PARATUS GOMA-MOMBASA ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 DRC RWANDA KENYA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

AIRTEL SATELLITE-TO-MOBILE SERVICE WITH STARLINK

- **Airtel Uganda Rolls Out Starlink Satellite-to-Mobile Service** — Tech Africa News, 24 September 2026

  Airtel Uganda launched Starlink satellite-to-mobile service, giving compatible smartphones SMS and light data such as WhatsApp outside terrestrial coverage, free for a 30-day trial and then through data bundles. Uganda is Airtel Africa's second commercial market for the service after the DRC in August.

UGANDA TELECOM REVIVAL AGREEMENT

- **Museveni Orders Cancellation of UTel Deal, Calls Investors 'Bafere' Over Missing $25 Million** — Nile Post, 9 October 2026

  Uganda's President Yoweri Museveni ordered the cancellation of the government's agreement with Rowad Capital Commercial to revive Uganda Telecom at a State House meeting on 6 October 2026, according to unnamed meeting sources. The investor had not paid the initial US$25 million of a US$225 million package in four years. Ministries are to prepare a Cabinet paper on state funding for the revival.

Data Storage

THIRD NATIONAL DATA CENTRE IN THE NITA-U STRATEGIC PLAN

- **Blogs: Plan now for infrastructure to power AI** — New Vision, 10 October 2026

Godfrey Mutabazi, director of Net Studios Africa, argues in a New Vision opinion column that Uganda needs a 10–15-year national compute and data-centre programme. He notes that the national backbone connects more than 1,600 government sites and that the 2025/26–2029/30 strategic plan provides for a third national data centre in Entebbe, with disaster recovery in Jinja.

Cybersecurity

CENTRAL BANK INTERNAL SECURITY SYSTEMS

- **Bank of Uganda strengthens security measures** — ITWeb Africa, 9 September 2026

  Bank of Uganda's governor told Parliament's Public Accounts Committee that the central bank has strengthened its internal security systems after a physical break-in and allegations of system manipulation at its headquarters. He said the incidents involved a physical breach and fraudulent payments rather than an external cyberattack.

FINANCIAL-SECTOR CYBER AND FRAUD INCIDENTS

- **Uganda Records 6,533 Cyber and Fraud Incidents, Losses Hit Shs24bn** — Nile Post, 23 September 2026

  The Uganda Bankers' Association counted 6,533 cyber and fraud incidents in the financial sector from January to August 2026, with UGX 24 billion lost and a further UGX 68 billion estimated at risk. At the same forum the Deputy Chief Justice said the judiciary is open to specialised handling of cyber and financial crime.

DPI

Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

Data Exchange

REVENUE-AUTHORITY ENFORCEMENT OF A THIRD COUNTRY'S IMPORT E-PERMIT CHARGE

- **On The Spot: URA Links With US-Sanctioned South Sudan Firm Crawford Capital Raises Concern - The Capital Times** — The Capital Times, 1 September 2026 SOUTH SUDAN KENYA

  The Capital Times reports that Uganda's and Kenya's revenue authorities still enforce e-Permit collections at border points for Crawford Capital, a firm the United States sanctioned on 12 May 2026 over diverting South Sudanese public funds. The UK-registered company collects a dollar charge on imports bound for South Sudan; documents cited show the Uganda Revenue Authority shares customs data with South Sudan's revenue authority but do not show a direct contract.

INTERNATIONALLY SHARED FINANCIAL DATA IN TAX ENFORCEMENT

- **URA tightens net on undeclared foreign income, offers window to regularise** — VividVoice, 13 September 2026

  The Uganda Revenue Authority has begun sending notices to taxpayers whose names and tax numbers have been matched to foreign income or assets through international data exchange under the Convention on Mutual Administrative Assistance in Tax Matters. Affected residents have until mid-2027 to make voluntary disclosures and amend three years of returns before the data are used for audits and investigations.

UGPASS

- **NITA-U moves to replace paper-based land verification with digital checks** — New Vision, 17 September 2026

Uganda's IT authority is building a digital signature and document-authentication service on the national authentication platform, binding a signature cryptographically to the holder's national identification number so land sale agreements, transfer forms and consent letters can be signed digitally. The integration platform is to carry real-time verification to the registration authority, so a lands office checks the register rather than a photocopied card; forged signatures in land transactions are the stated first target.

UGHUB

- **News: NIRA to register learners, correct identity errors in December** — New Vision, 1 October 2026

  Uganda's National Identification and Registration Authority announced on 1 October 2026 a nationwide exercise in December, run at local council level, to register schoolchildren without National Identification Numbers and correct errors in identity records. At the same event the national IT authority said its UGHub links NIRA's register to more than 150 government bodies, banks and telecoms for real-time verification.

Digital Identity and CRVS

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION NUMBER AND THE TAXPAYER NUMBER

- **What 'NIN Will Replace TIN in All Transactions' Actually Means** — Business Times Uganda, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's cabinet approved phasing out the standalone taxpayer identification number for individuals, replacing it with the national identification number already printed on the identity card. Nothing states a commencement date or a transition arrangement for the roughly nine to ten million Ugandans not yet on the register.

- **Minister Musasizi Explains Why NIN Is to Be Used as TIN as ICPAU Commits to Enforce AI Adoption in Accountancy Sector** — Mulengera News, 3 September 2026

  Uganda's finance minister, Henry Musasizi, said on 3 September 2026 that Cabinet's decision of 31 August does not replace the tax identification number with the national identification number, but requires the two to be interoperable. He said linking them would show who of taxable age and income is missing from the tax register.

- **URA Explains Use of NINs to Replace TINs** — Nilepost, 7 September 2026

  Uganda's revenue authority says the move from taxpayer numbers to national identification numbers will not automatically make every citizen a taxpayer, the purpose being a single more secure identifier for government services and more accurate taxpayer records. It follows the finance minister's statement four days earlier that the two numbers must be interoperable rather than one replacing the other.

- **Transitioning from TIN to NIN will create jobs and open up formal markets** — New Vision, 16 September 2026

  Uganda's revenue authority said the taxpayer identification number will be phased out for individuals in favour of the national identification number, with companies using their registration number instead. It said the old system reached only just over 5 million taxpayers and that the change will remove duplicate and ghost records.

- **Government launches integration of National ID, tax identification systems** — NTV Uganda, 30 September 2026

  Uganda's internal affairs minister launched the integration of the national identification and tax identification systems at the country's first Identity Expo and Symposium in Kampala.

- **Linking NINs to Tax Records Will Tackle Identity Theft, Says URA** — Nile Post, 30 September 2026

The Uganda Revenue Authority is moving to the National Identification Number as individuals' tax identifier, first mapping existing tax numbers to NINs, then taking fingerprint consent at URA service points. Basic biodata such as name, date of birth and photograph is drawn from the national identity authority's servers. Companies receive an entity number from the business registry, URSB.

PEOPLE ON THE NATIONAL REGISTER

- **NIRA register reaches 36.15 million people** — New Vision, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's identification authority holds 36.15 million people on the national register, close to 77% of a population the 2024 census put at 45.9 million, leaving nine to ten million unregistered. The figure matters because cabinet has just made that register the basis of tax identity.

TAX IDENTIFICATION NUMBER MERGED INTO THE NATIONAL ID NUMBER

- **ANDREW BABA: URA's TIN to NIN Migration, The Benefits and Risks of Uganda's New Tax Identity System** — Insight Post Uganda, 2 September 2026

  Analyst Andrew Baba reviews the Uganda Revenue Authority's move from the Tax Identification Number to the National Identification Number, run with the national registration authority NIRA. He says a single identifier should reduce duplicate tax identities and ease verification across government, but concentrates privacy, access and cybersecurity risks. No dates or figures for the migration are given.

- **Minister Musasizi Explains Why NIN Is to Be Used as TIN as ICPAU Commits to Enforce AI Adoption in Accountancy Sector** — Mulengera News, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **URA Explains Use of NINs to Replace TINs** — Nilepost, 7 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

ID CARDS PRINTED AGAINST COLLECTED

- **NIRA staffing crisis leaves millions of IDs gathering dust** — The Independent, 9 September 2026

  Uganda's National Identification and Registration Authority told Parliament on 8 September 2026 that about 5.4 million printed ID cards are uncollected, of roughly 15.4 million printed. Its executive director said 418 of 571 approved posts are filled, only 201 client-facing, and asked for 998 posts plus at least 2,700 temporary staff for 18 months. About 10.9 million Ugandans remain unregistered.

NIRA STAFFING AGAINST APPROVED ESTABLISHMENT

- **NIRA staffing crisis leaves millions of IDs gathering dust** — The Independent, 9 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

NATIONAL SECURE IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **NIRA on Spot as New National IDs Fail to Work for SIM Registration, Banks and Driving Permits** — Business Focus, 11 September 2026

  Uganda's new national identity cards cannot yet be used for SIM registration, banking or driving permits because partner institutions have not connected to the registration authority NIRA's data-exchange module, MPs heard on 9 September 2026. NIRA's director Rosemary Kisembo said the module began on 31 March 2026 and MTN was the first partner onboarded. The committee chair asked NIRA not to recall old IDs and to set activation timelines.

IDENTITY-ANCHORED DIGITAL SIGNATURE FOR LAND DOCUMENTS

- **NITA-U moves to replace paper-based land verification with digital checks** — New Vision, 17 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

LOCAL PRINTING OF SECURE DOCUMENTS (UGANDA SECURITY PRINTING COMPANY)

- **Secure documents to be printed locally** — New Vision, 29 September 2026

  Uganda Security Printing Company said on 29 September 2026 that it will print the country's secure documents locally at a new factory, using security features supplied by the National Identification and Registration Authority for the national ID card. It named passports, driving permits, land titles, education certificates and ballot papers among its products. No start date or cost is given.

SHARE OF THE POPULATION IDENTIFIED

- **Identity is the Foundation of Security, Development, Says Minister Kamuntu as NIRA Expo Opens** — Nile Post, 29 September 2026

  Figures at the opening of Uganda's first national identity expo put about 36.2 million people identified, roughly 78.8% of the population. The internal affairs minister called on the registration authority to reach everyone.

LEARNER REGISTRATION AND IDENTITY-RECORD CORRECTION EXERCISE

- **News: NIRA to register learners, correct identity errors in December** — New Vision, 1 October 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

Digital Payments and Fintech

KAMPALA-ENTEBBE EXPRESSWAY TOLL COLLECTION

- **Mobile Money Toll Payments Coming to Kampala-Entebbe Expressway** — ChimpReports, 11 September 2026

  Uganda's Ministry of Works and Transport said on 10 September 2026 that test runs of mobile money toll payment on the Kampala-Entebbe Expressway were complete, with dedicated lanes to follow. It did not say which platforms, what charges or when. Parliament's infrastructure committee is examining the reported UGX 122 billion five-year toll operation contract with Egis.

- **MTN Uganda Launches Mobile Money Toll Payments on Kampala-Entebbe Expressway** — Tech Africa News, 25 September 2026

  MTN Uganda and the Ministry of Works and Transport launched Mobile Money toll payment on the Kampala-Entebbe Expressway, at the Busega, Kajjansi and Mpala plazas on designated lanes. The motorist gives a phone number to the attendant and approves a PIN prompt; no fee was named.

EACBOND REGIONAL CUSTOMS GUARANTEE

- **Afreximbank issues a $29 million guarantee to scale EAC Customs Bond, easing movement of goods across East Africa** — African Export-Import Bank (Afreximbank), 22 September 2026 EAST AFRICA

  Afreximbank issued a US$29m guarantee to BSMART Technology on 22 September 2026 to scale the EAC Customs Bond, a digital regional customs guarantee that removes the need to post paper bonds at each border. The bond was piloted from August 2025 and launched at the East African Community heads of state summit in March 2026.

PRIDE BANK SERVICES ON THE INTERSWITCH AGENT AND CARD NETWORK

- **Pride Bank and Interswitch join forces to deliver easier, accessible banking solutions to customers** — The Independent (Uganda), 22 September 2026

  Uganda's Pride Bank launched a partnership with Interswitch that offers selected banking services through Interswitch's network of more than 21,000 Quickteller agents and issues Pride Bank Verve debit cards. Agents will handle deposits, withdrawals, loan repayments and bill payments. No financial terms are given.

Registries

SUGAR INDUSTRY INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Trade Ministry launches digital system to register sugarcane farmers** — New Vision, 3 September 2026

  Uganda's Ministry of Trade, Industry and Cooperatives launched the Sugar Industry Information Management System with the National Sugar Stakeholders Council to register every sugarcane grower. Trade minister Sanjay Tanna said the satellite-linked system will gather data across cultivation, milling and markets. He also warned millers against unilateral deductions from the agreed cane price of UGX 125,000. The exact launch date is not given.

DIGITAL NUMBER PLATE SYSTEM

- **Parliament Probes Digital Plate Crisis as Delays Cost Uganda Shs4bn Weekly** — Business Times Uganda, 6 September 2026

  Uganda's parliamentary Committee on Physical Infrastructure began a three-week inquiry on 2 September 2026 into delays in issuing digital number plates, which its chairman Mwine Mpaka said cost more than Shs4 billion a week. The committee heard daily plate output had fallen from about 350 to 100; first registration now costs Shs714,300, against about Shs137,000 for the old plates. The contractor, Joint Stock Company Global Security, is to be questioned.

- **MPs grill digital plate makers over Shs4b weekly losses** — Daily Monitor (Uganda), 29 September 2026

  Uganda's parliamentary committee on physical infrastructure questioned Joint Stock Company Global Security, the Russian-based maker of digital number plates under the Intelligent Transport Monitoring System, on 28 September 2026 over revenue losses of at least Shs4 billion a week. The committee chair said daily output had fallen from 350 to under 100 sets, and some upcountry centres had stopped issuing plates for lack of kits.

- **Ministry clears digital number plate backlog amid Parliamentary scrutiny** — Daily Monitor (Uganda), 30 September 2026

  Uganda's Ministry of Works and Transport told Parliament's physical infrastructure committee that the digital number plate backlog has been cleared after component supplies were restored in August 2026. Average fitting time at Kampala bonds fell from 19 days in December 2025 to two days in September 2026; the ministry linked the registration system to a 17% rise in taxes.

- **MPs Verify, Confirm Digital Number Plate System is Working During Naguru Command Centre Visit** — Nile Post, 3 October 2026

  Uganda's parliamentary Committee on Physical Infrastructure watched police track four Parliament vehicles live through the Digital Number Plate System at the Naguru command centre. Police said 337 of 375 stolen vehicles had been tracked and recovered. MPs asked for faster response to tamper alerts, and the Ministry of Works and Transport is linking the registration database to owners' contact details.

- **Attorney General declares 2021 digital number plates contract null, illegal** — Daily Monitor, 6 October 2026

Uganda's Attorney General told a parliamentary committee that the supplier of the digital number plate system has consistently failed the core obligations of its 2021 contract, which the newspaper reports him declaring null and illegal. Defaults cited include no training of Ugandan staff and no transfer of the system's technology to the state enterprise.

- **How ignored warnings, missing feasibility studies plagued Uganda's digital plates project** — Daily Monitor (Uganda), 13 October 2026

  A former works minister told a Ugandan parliamentary committee that the digital number plate rollout went ahead without a preliminary feasibility study, and a former internal affairs minister said early warnings were ignored. The contractor defended plate fees paid to it rather than into the Consolidated Fund.

- **MPs Order Detention of Two Auditors Over Unaudited Digital Number Plate Project** — Nile Post, 14 October 2026

  Uganda's parliamentary Physical Infrastructure Committee ordered two directors of the Office of the Auditor General detained after they said the digital number plate project (ITMS) has not been audited since it began in 2021. The Auditor General said the project was classed as security-related and is financed by the Russian firm Joint Stock Company Global Security; motorists pay over Shs750,000 a plate.

MODULAR MOTOR VEHICLE REGISTRATION COMPONENTS PROCUREMENT

- **Whistleblowers ask Museveni, IGG to halt Shs158bn digital plates deal** — Daily Star Uganda, 27 September 2026

  Whistleblowers asked President Museveni, the Inspectorate of Government, the Auditor General and the procurement regulator to halt a proposed Shs158 billion Ministry of Works and Transport purchase of vehicle registration components from Global Security, the contractor for Uganda's digital number plates. They say it pays twice for functions already covered and gives one foreign vendor the registry and its data. The paper says the claims were not independently established.

DIGITISATION OF THE CHIEF REGISTRAR'S ADVOCATES AND BAILIFFS RECORDS

- **Uganda: Judiciary Digitises Advocates, Bailiffs Records to Improve Access** — allAfrica, 9 October 2026

  Uganda's Judiciary is digitising the Chief Registrar's records on advocates and bailiffs. When Chief Registrar Agnes Alum inspected the work at the Court of Appeal building in Kampala, all files had been scanned; capturing their data into a searchable system comes next, with the first phase due by the end of October 2026.

LAND REGISTRY DIGITISATION

- **Government Moves to Reduce Cost of Obtaining Land Titles** — Nile Post, 11 October 2026

  Uganda's minister of state for lands, Harriet Ntabazi, said new digital systems let land-title applicants enter their data at district level and have titles printed without travelling between offices. She said some landowners had paid more than Shs2.5 million to surveyors and land boards, and that surveyors will be registered in the ministry's database.

Sectoral management information systems

E-WARD ROUND REMOTE SPECIALIST PLATFORM

- **Chil Group Launches Digital Platform Linking Rural Hospitals to Urban Specialists** — Nilepost, 3 September 2026

Ugandan digital health company Chil Group launched an E-Ward Round Platform on 3 September 2026 that lets urban specialists hold virtual ward rounds with rural inpatient teams. It links to Chil's free electronic medical record software and bedside devices, uses an AI model to rank urgent cases, and gives each bed a cryptographic token to hide patient identities. The company says its partner facilities have more than 260 wards.

PARISH DEVELOPMENT MODEL INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **Alarm raised as 50% of Zombo PDM tablets fail to function** — ChimpReports, 11 September 2026

  Thirty-one of the 61 Parish Development Model tablets issued in Uganda's Zombo District do not work, forcing parishes back to paper records, district officials said. The tablets handle data capture, disbursement tracking, biometric verification and the Wendi digital wallet, and ICT ministry rules bar local repair. Zombo has disbursed UGX 21.6bn to 22,263 beneficiaries since 2022.

- **Uganda's Parish Development Model Reaches 3.5 Million Beneficiaries With $1.1 Billion Government Investment** — The Kampala Report, 18 September 2026

  An inter-ministerial meeting put Uganda's Parish Development Model at 3,571,108 beneficiaries against UGX 4.317 trillion capitalised through 10,589 parish SACCOs, lending up to UGX 1 million at 6 per cent a year. It says 183,430 of 222,389 enterprise groups are profiled on the programme's information system; the figures are the government's own.

DIGITAL TAX STAMPS

- **URA lauds Manufacturers on DTS success** — Nile Post, 15 September 2026

  The Uganda Revenue Authority told the Uganda Manufacturers Association in Kampala that more than 1,680 manufacturers and importers are registered on its Digital Tax Stamps portal, run by SICPA Uganda since 2018, Nile Post reported on 15 September 2026. The authority said the stamps and its EFRIS e-invoicing system supported nearly 40% growth in domestic revenue in 2024/25, and that stamp costs are tax-deductible.

HEALTH FACILITY ELECTRONIC MEDICAL RECORD SYSTEM

- **Health: Kiryandongo health facilities struggle with EMR system** — New Vision (Uganda), 21 September 2026

  Health workers in Uganda's Kiryandongo district told a public meeting on 19 September 2026 that the Ministry of Health's electronic medical record system is slowing care, citing poor connectivity, unstable power and too few computers. Nyakadoti Health Centre III, serving about 40,000 people including refugees, reported long queues, and the district hospital said services stop when power fails.

ELECTRONIC COURT CASE MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM (ECCMIS)

- **Judiciary Cleans Case Records Ahead of ECCMIS Rollout in Nine Courts** — Uganda Radio Network, 10 October 2026

  Uganda's Judiciary is reconciling physical case files with its existing case administration system in nine courts, including Mpigi High Court, from 6 to 16 October 2026. The exercise prepares those courts to move onto the Electronic Court Case Management Information System (ECCMIS). No go-live date is given.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ELECTRONIC GOVERNMENT PROCUREMENT SYSTEM

- **Musasizi Tasks Accountants on Fiscal Discipline, Accountability** — Ministry of Finance, Planning and Economic Development (Uganda), 3 September 2026

> Uganda's finance minister, Henry Musasizi, told the 31st annual seminar of the Institute of Certified Public Accountants of Uganda in Entebbe that accountants must support fiscal discipline and evidence-based decisions. He said the government is implementing reforms including electronic government procurement to improve budget outcomes.

> POLICE ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE CHATBOT

- **Uganda: UPF Set to Launch AI Chatbot to Improve Access to Police Services** — Nile Post, syndicated by allAfrica, 3 September 2026

  The Uganda Police Force said it will introduce an AI chatbot giving the public guidance on emergencies and police services, demonstrated at its ICT facility at Kikandwa in Wakiso District. Officers said it will be rolled out across the country and will not replace the 999 emergency line. No launch date is given.

> FREE PUBLIC ACCESS TO THE ELECTRONIC UGANDA GAZETTE

- **UPPC opens free digital access to the Uganda Gazette** — Uganda Printing and Publishing Corporation (UPPC), 7 October 2026

  The Uganda Printing and Publishing Corporation, the government printer, announced on 7 October 2026 that the E-Gazette is now free to the public on its website. Gazette editions back to 1902 have been digitised, and its 2023–2028 strategic plan aims to digitise 80% of its products and systems by 2028.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Digitalisation of sub-national government

> SIMPLIFIED COMPUTERISED ACCOUNTING AND REPORTING TOOL (SCART)

- **Govt rolls out digital tool to improve financial accountability in Hoima city** — New Vision (Uganda), 23 September 2026

  Uganda's Ministry of Local Government launched SCART, a web-based accounting and reporting tool, in Hoima city's two divisions on 22 September 2026. The ministry said it has reached 66 units so far: 25 lower local governments and 41 health units and schools. It standardises accounting, budgeting and financial reporting.

Technology

AI · ICT Industry · Innovation ecosystem

AI

> SANDI AI SMALLHOLDER CREDIT SCORING

- **Ugandan Startup SANDI AI Wins Shs190M GoGettaz Agripreneur Prize** — Nilepost, 5 September 2026

  Ugandan startup SANDI AI Technologies won the 2026 GoGettaz Agripreneur Prize of US$50,000, about UGX 190 million, at the Africa Food Systems Forum in Kigali, reported on 5 September 2026. Founded by Sandra Nabakka, it uses AI and farm data to assess smallholders without collateral for unsecured loans. The date of the award is not given.

> OPENSCOPES AIDDIA AI MICROSCOPY PROGRAMME, MBARARA UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

- **R101m UCT project brings AI microscopy to Africa** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA KENYA CÔTE D'IVOIRE

The University of Cape Town launched openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, Wellcome Trust-funded programme worth GBP 4.4 million (about R101 million) pairing open-source microscopy with machine-learning image analysis for research on TB, malaria and other infectious diseases. Partners are KEMRI, Uganda's Mbarara University, Côte d'Ivoire's CSRS and Imperial College London.

COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR'S AI SYSTEM FOR FILTERING HARMFUL ONLINE CONTENT

- **Govt Eyes AI Tool to Tackle Rising Nude, Explicit Content on Social Media** — Nilepost, 25 September 2026

  Uganda's ICT minister, Justine Kasule Lumumba, said the Uganda Communications Commission is procuring an AI system to identify and filter sexually explicit and other harmful content before it is distributed online, and that it must understand local languages. The system, its cost, supplier and deployment date are not given.

ENTEBBE AIRPORT AI NUMBER-PLATE PARKING SYSTEM

- **Smarter parking at Entebbe: UCAA rolls out AI camera system, digital payments** — Daily Monitor, 9 October 2026

  The Uganda Civil Aviation Authority has upgraded the car parks at Entebbe International Airport with AI-assisted number-plate recognition, supplied through local contractor Samanga Utilities on Scheidt & Bachmann software, and mobile-money payment. The authority said it keeps vehicle registration records, timestamps and payment logs indefinitely and releases them to security agencies and police under statutory guidelines.

ICT Industry

ACQUISITION OF A DOMESTIC BANKING-SOFTWARE FIRM

- **CreditChek rachète Algosys pour faciliter le crédit en Afrique de l'Est** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026
  NIGERIA

  A Nigerian technology company has acquired a Ugandan banking-software firm, bringing every stage of credit - from verifying the borrower's identity to repayment - onto a single platform. The companies say the combination lets African financial institutions assess loan applications faster and lend more readily; no price is disclosed.

Innovation ecosystem

AFRICA-EUROPE DIGITAL INNOVATION BRIDGE 2.0 (AEDIB 2.0)

- **Tender Specifications: Consultancy for Development of a Women in Tech (WiT) Community Platform, and EU-Africa Venture Sourcing (TZA25001-10031)** — Enabel (Belgian Development Agency), 21 September 2026
  TANZANIA SENEGAL

  Enabel, the Belgian development agency, issued tender specifications for a consultancy to build a Women in Tech community platform and source 12 EU-Africa ventures under its AEDIB 2.0 programme in Tanzania, Uganda and Senegal for 2026 to 2028. The procedure is negotiated without prior publication; bids close on 23 October 2026. No contract value is stated.

NATIONAL E-BOOSTER PROGRAMME, PHASE III

- **UCC seeks partner to accelerate local ICT innovations under third e-Booster phase** — PML Daily, 29 September 2026

  The Uganda Communications Commission re-advertised on 29 September 2026 a call for one implementing partner to run Phase III of its National e-Booster Programme in 2026/27, funded through the levy-based universal service fund UCUSAF. The partner will select, mentor and incubate local ICT innovations and assess the national innovation ecosystem; proposals close on 12 October. No budget is given.

Capacity

Literacy · Training and skills · Research institutions

Literacy

OPERATOR MOBILE-CLASSROOM DIGITAL AND FINANCIAL LITERACY PROGRAMME

- **MTN programme trains 305 Ugandans in digital, financial skills** — Nile Post, 20 September 2026

  305 people graduated in Kampala from the sixth phase of a mobile-classroom digital and financial literacy programme run by the largest mobile operator's foundation, taking the number trained to more than 6,700. The training covers safe internet use, digital productivity and the use of digital financial services.

Training and skills

TECHNICIAN DIPLOMAS IN CYBER SECURITY AND DATA SCIENCE

- **TVET Council approves new technician diplomas in cyber security and data science** — UG Standard, 14 September 2026

  Uganda's TVET Council approved new national technician diploma curricula including cyber security, digital forensics and governance, and data science and analytics, alongside engineering and construction courses, its executive director Moses Kasakya said. Colleges may teach them only once accredited, and institutions have been asked to apply.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN THE TECHNICAL AND VOCATIONAL CURRICULUM

- **Govt introduces AI training in TVET** — New Vision, 15 September 2026

  Uganda has added artificial intelligence modules to 17 new specialised technician diploma curricula in its revised technical and vocational training system. A trainer orientation ran from 14 to 18 September 2026 at Nakawa Vocational College. Trainers said instructors need to understand the technology first and that institutions lack the laboratories and computers to teach the modules.

MTN ACE DIGITAL SKILLING PROGRAMME

- **Digital Hubs Must Equip Youth for Jobs, says PS Zawedde** — Nile Post, 16 September 2026

  MTN Foundation Uganda and the ICT ministry handed over a second innovation hub at Busitema University, part of a Shs4 billion three-year programme for four university hubs and a refurbished national hub in Kampala. The programme expects to reach more than 20,000 students and community members.

Research institutions

JAPANESE DEVELOPMENT AGENCY RESEARCH COLLABORATION WITH THE NATIONAL UNIVERSITY

- **JICA, Makerere University Explore New Frontiers in AI and Research Collaboration** — Makerere University News, 4 September 2026

  Makerere University and Japan's international cooperation agency explored strengthening academic, research and innovation collaboration between Uganda, Japan and other African countries, with a focus on artificial intelligence, aerospace engineering, materials and remote sensing, food value chains, energy, water and climate change.

Inclusion

Access to services · Digital divides

Access to services

REFUGEE INTERNET USE BY GENDER

- **Closing the digital divide for refugee women means understanding their full experience of connectivity** — GSMA Mobile for Humanitarian Innovation (Zainab Moallin), 10 September 2026 ETHIOPIA TANZANIA MAURITANIA GLOBAL

  The GSMA published research on 10 September 2026 on refugee women's mobile use, drawing on fieldwork with Venezuelan refugees in Colombia and in Mauritania's Mbera camp. It reports that refugee women in Ethiopia are twice as likely to have SIMs registered in someone else's name, that in Uganda about a quarter use the internet against half of men, and that in Tanzania identity rules push women to register SIMs through intermediaries.

- **Digital inclusion for refugee women must go beyond connectivity: GSMA** — Biometric Update, 14 September 2026 ETHIOPIA TANZANIA GLOBAL

  GSMA research finds identity rules for SIM registration push refugee women in Ethiopia and Tanzania to register lines in others' names, limiting control of mobile money and communication. In Uganda about 25% of refugee women use the internet against 50% of men.

SMART VILLAGES PILOT

- **Buhadyo Primary School Smart Classroom Enhancing E-Learning in Butaleja District** — Ministry of ICT and National Guidance, Uganda, 23 September 2026

  Uganda's ICT ministry said a smart classroom at Buhadyo Primary School in Butaleja District, built with Huawei under the Smart Villages pilot, lets pupils join the same e-learning lessons as Nakasero Primary School in Kampala. The pilot adds a telecoms tower and a 120-panel solar system that also powers 25 households. No cost is given.

Digital divides

OYAM RURAL COMMUNITY BROADBAND NETWORK

- **Free internet access excites traders in Oyam market** — The Observer (Uganda), 14 September 2026

  A rural community broadband network built by the Women of Uganda Network with netLabs!UG and the Internet Society Foundation is in technical testing at 12 sites in Uganda's Oyam district. Market traders already use it instead of buying mobile data; one vendor put her former spend at about Shs5,000 a day. More than 60 people have received digital literacy training.

Data

National statistics

National statistics

FOURTH PLAN FOR NATIONAL STATISTICAL DEVELOPMENT

- **UBOS partners with Samia Bugwe and Tieng Adhola to improve community data** — Uganda Broadcasting Corporation, 6 September 2026

  The Uganda Bureau of Statistics signed memoranda of understanding with the Samia Bugwe and Tieng Adhola cultural institutions to collect and share community data, with a focus on births and deaths. The bureau will help the institutions set up statistics units and train staff. No cost or timetable is given.

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